# StoryCast: Research Document

Information architecture, wireframes and high-fidelity mockups for an accessible media feature microsite.

## 1. Project summary

StoryCast is a three-page microsite that shares short audio and video stories from everyday communities. Its design goal is that every story can be heard, watched *and* read: captions and transcripts are part of the layout, not an add-on. The build uses semantic HTML5, Sass and vanilla JavaScript only.

## 2. Users and needs

| User | Need | Design response |
|---|---|---|
| Deaf or hard-of-hearing listener | Access to spoken content | Synced WebVTT captions on by default; full transcript on the page |
| Screen-reader user | Clear structure and labels | Landmarks, one h1 per page, labelled sections, aria-current |
| Keyboard-only user | Reach everything without a mouse | Skip link, logical tab order, high-visibility focus ring, button-based transcript seeking |
| Low-vision user | Readable text at any size | AA contrast, rem-based type and spacing, layout that survives 200% zoom |
| Mobile listener on a slow connection | Light pages, easy reading | No frameworks, small media files, responsive Grid/Flexbox layout |

## 3. Information architecture

### 3.1 Sitemap

Three page types: Home, Story Detail (one page per story, all sharing one template) and About / Access. Primary navigation is on every page; Story pages add a breadcrumb and a

related-stories sidebar so users move between stories without returning home.
*[Insert image here: docs/img/sitemap.png. Alt text: Sitemap diagram. Home links to three story pages and the About page. Story pages link to each other through related stories and back to Home through the breadcrumb and logo.]*
**Editable sitemap (FigJam):**
https://www.figma.com/board/AyzQPvLUD0G3KRdNnRmUJL/StoryCast-Sitemap

### 3.2 Content hierarchy per page

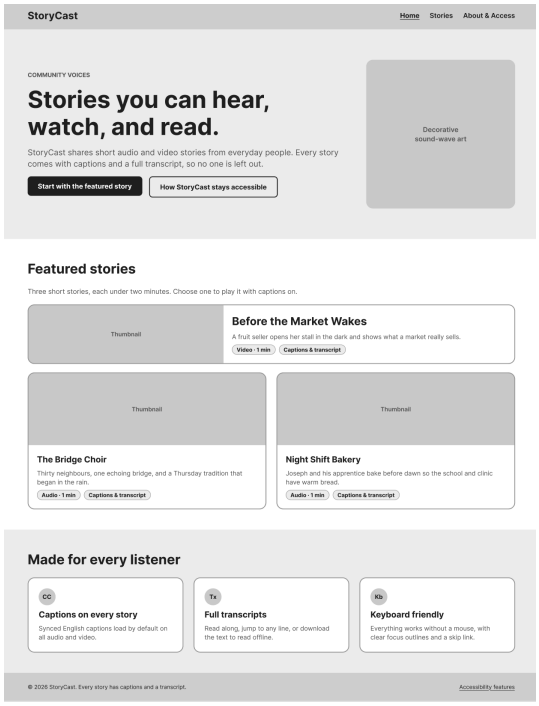
| Page | Heading outline |
|---|---|
| Home | h1 Stories you can hear, watch, and read. → h2 Featured stories (h3 per story) → h2 Made for every listener (h3 per feature) |
| Story detail | h1 Story title → media figure with figcaption → h2 Transcript → aside h2 Related stories (h3 per card) |
| About / Access | h1 About StoryCast → h2 Our mission, Accessibility features (h3 per feature), How to engage, Known limitations |

### 3.3 Navigation model

A three-item main nav (Home, Stories, About & Access) keeps the structure flat, so no menu toggle is needed and nothing is hidden behind JavaScript. The current page is marked with aria-current="page" and an underline, so it does not depend on colour.

## 4. Wireframes

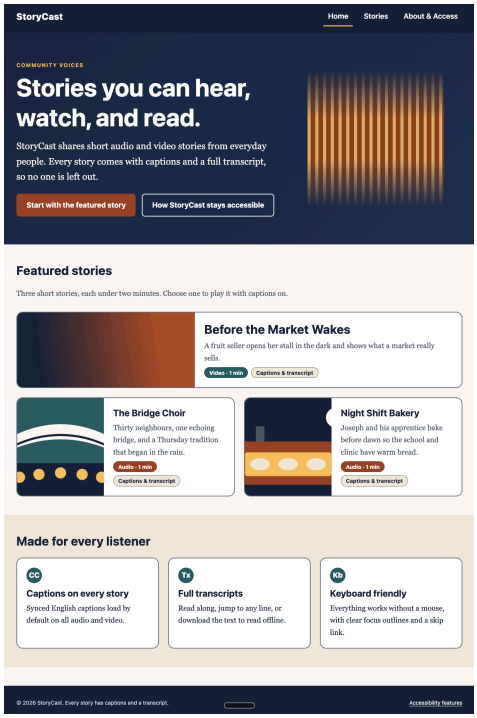
Low-fidelity wireframes fix layout and content priority before any colour or type decisions. Red notes in the Figma file call out behaviour such as the container query.




**Wireframes (Figma, page “Wireframes”):**

https://www.figma.com/design/7BqGiKftWJIWfy6c5X2Y9V/StoryCast---Wireframes-and-Mockups (Home, Story, About, Home mobile)

# 5. High-fidelity mockups




**Mockups (Figma, page “High-fidelity mockups”):**

https://www.figma.com/design/7BqGiKftWJlWfy6c5X2Y9V/StoryCast---Wireframes-and-Mockups

## Design decisions and reasoning

| Decision | Reason |
| --- | --- |
| Warm cream background, deep navy text | 15:1 contrast, comfortable for long reading, less glare than pure white |
| Terracotta accent (#a33a16) | Distinct brand colour that still reaches 6.3:1 on cream and 6.6:1 with white text |
| Serif body, sans-serif headings and UI | Serif suits storytelling; sans-serif makes controls and headings scan quickly. System fonts avoid extra requests |
| Transcript directly under the player | Equal prominence to the media; the transcript is part of the story, not a hidden extra |
| Cards whose layout depends on their own width | The same card works in the main grid, a wide featured slot and the narrow sidebar (container queries) |

| Decision | Reason |
| --- | --- |
| Badges that say “Video”, “Audio”, “Captions” | Text labels, so type and features are not conveyed by colour alone |

## 6. Accessibility strategy (WCAG 2.1 AA)

| Principle | Planned measures |
| --- | --- |
| Perceivable | Captions (1.2.2), transcripts (1.2.1), AA contrast (1.4.3), text resize and reflow (1.4.4, 1.4.10), non-text alternatives (1.1.1) |
| Operable | Keyboard access (2.1.1), skip link (2.4.1), page titles (2.4.2), visible focus (2.4.7), reduced motion |
| Understandable | lang on every page, consistent navigation (3.2.3), plain language |
| Robust | Valid semantic HTML, names/roles/states for custom controls (4.1.2) |

## 7. Responsive plan

| Technique | Where |
| --- | --- |
| CSS Grid | Page shell, auto-fit card and feature grids, story page (main + sidebar) |
| Flexbox | Header, nav, badges, footer, transcript header |
| Media queries | Hero two-column at 48rem, story sidebar at 64rem |
| Container query | Media card: stacked by default, horizontal when its container is at least 30rem |